BUSINESS PLAN

AeroDesk

The Modern Marketplace for Pre-Owned Aircraft

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1. Executive Summary

AeroDesk is a next-generation digital marketplace for pre-owned aircraft, designed to bring consumer-grade user experience to an industry that has been underserved by technology. The platform targets the global used aircraft market, valued at approximately USD 37.5 billion in 2024, with projections reaching USD 78.6 billion by 2035 at a 6.97% CAGR.

The opportunity is clear: the dominant marketplace, Controller.com (owned by Sandhills Global, estimated revenue of USD 18.2 million), operates with a legacy UX rooted in print classifieds. App Store reviews consistently cite poor mobile usability and counterintuitive search. Meanwhile, Brazil's executive aviation fleet of 9,824 aircraft (per ANAC 2023 data) is served only by fragmented local platforms like AeronavesAVenda.com and Aeromercado.com.br, none of which deliver a modern buying experience.

AeroDesk will differentiate by delivering a Webmotors-quality interface—beautiful photography, intuitive filters, AI-powered pricing insights, and a seamless mobile-first experience—to the aircraft vertical. The platform will launch first in Brazil (leveraging local market knowledge and lower CAC) before expanding to Latin America and global English-speaking markets.

Revenue model: Tiered listing subscriptions for dealers (Basic/Premium/Enterprise), featured placement fees, lead-generation commissions, and fintech integration (financing referral fees). We project reaching USD 2.8 million in annual revenue by Year 3, with positive EBITDA by the end of Year 3.

Seed capital requirement: Approximately USD 920,000 to fund 18 months of development, go-to-market, and initial operations.

2. Market Overview

2.1 Global Used Aircraft Market

The global used aircraft market represents one of the most resilient segments within aerospace. According to Market Research Future (MRFR), the market was valued at USD 37.46 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 78.61 billion by 2035, growing at a CAGR of 6.97%. Key growth drivers include rising demand for cost-effective fleet solutions, digital transformation of sales channels, and supply chain delays in new aircraft production that push buyers toward pre-owned inventory.

Metric	2024	2035 (Projected)
Market Size (USD)	$37.46 Billion	$78.61 Billion
CAGR	N/A	6.97%
New Jet Deliveries (GAMA 2024)	764 units	—
OEM Backlog Value (Q2 2025)	$55.5 Billion	—
Pre-Owned Txn Growth (H1 2025)	+9.1% unit / +11.2% dollar YoY	—

GAMA's 2024 annual data reported 764 business jet deliveries (up from 730 in 2023), with total airplane delivery value reaching USD 26.4 billion, a 14.3% increase. OEM backlogs exceeded USD 55.5 billion by Q2 2025, indicating a book-to-bill ratio near 1:1 and sustained demand. Pre-owned transactions in H1 2025 rose 9.1% in unit volume and 11.2% in dollar volume year-over-year, driven by strong momentum from Q4 2024 and continued expansion of the business aviation user base.

Aircraft availability remained tight at approximately 7.3% of the total fleet (below the ~10% decade average), and listings of aircraft aged 12 years or younger declined 28.3% versus 2019, signaling robust absorption of premium inventory. Monthly sales ranged from 291 to 366 units in H1 2025, with the highest recorded single sale reaching USD 67.5 million. North America remains the dominant region, projected to represent 73.8% of the global business jet market through 2029.

2.2 Brazil: Latin America's Aviation Powerhouse

Brazil is the second-largest general aviation market in the world (behind only the United States) and the undisputed leader in Latin America. Key statistics from ANAC and industry sources:

Indicator	Data
Executive Aircraft Fleet (ANAC 2023)	9,824 aircraft (+2.4% YoY)
Total Registered Aircraft (RAB)	~28,000+ aircraft
Total Airports	3,240 (503 public, 2,737 private)
Embraer Executive Jet Deliveries (2024)	130 jets (+14% YoY total)

LABACE (Largest LatAm BizAv Show)	188,000+ visitors, 780 aircraft
Aviation MRO Sector Value (2024)	~USD 2.5 Billion

Brazil's executive aviation market has grown consistently since 2020, supported by Embraer's strong presence (the company delivered 130 executive jets in 2024 alone), a rising middle-to-upper class seeking private aviation, and a geographic context where commercial routes are limited outside major hubs. The country's sheer size (8.5 million km² with many underserved regions) makes private and executive aviation not a luxury but often a necessity for business.

Despite this scale, the digital infrastructure for aircraft transactions in Brazil is remarkably underdeveloped. Sellers rely on fragmented platforms (AeronavesAVenda.com with ~569 listings, Aeromercado.com.br, and direct broker networks like TAM Aviacao Executiva and Global Aircraft), Facebook groups, and WhatsApp networks. There is no single modern, trusted platform that aggregates supply, provides transparent pricing data, and offers a seamless buyer journey.

3. Competitive Landscape

3.1 Global Competitors

Platform	Monthly Visits	Listings	Revenue Model	UX Quality	Mobile App
Controller.com	~900K	5,500+	Subscriptions + ads	Legacy/Poor	Yes (low rated)
Trade-A-Plane	~400K	3,000+	Listing fees	Dated	No
AvBuyer	~250K	2,000+	Premium listings	Moderate	No
GlobalAir	~150K	1,500+	Ads + listings	Dated	No
AeroTrader	~100K	1,000+	Listing fees	Moderate	No
Aircraft24	~50K	800+	Subscriptions	Clean but basic	No

3.2 Brazil-Specific Competitors

In Brazil, there is no dominant digital aircraft marketplace. The landscape is fragmented across:

- **AeronavesAVenda.com:** The largest Brazilian-specific platform with ~569 listings. Basic classifieds-style interface, limited filtering, no pricing intelligence or financing integration.
- **Aeromercado.com.br:** Focused on light aircraft and general aviation. Very basic design. Free listing model. Small community.
- **TAM Aviacao Executiva:** Dealer/broker-operated inventory page. Not a marketplace. Limited to their own fleet.
- **Global Aircraft:** Brazil-US brokerage with growing team but operates as a traditional broker, not a platform.
- **WhatsApp groups and LABACE networking:** A significant amount of deal flow in Brazil happens through informal networks, industry events, and direct broker relationships.

3.3 Controller.com: The Incumbent to Disrupt

Controller.com, owned by Sandhills Global (a privately-held Nebraska-based conglomerate founded in 1978), is the world's leading aircraft marketplace with an estimated USD 18.2 million in revenue. It hosts over 5,500 active listings and draws approximately 900,000 monthly visits.

However, Controller's competitive advantage is purely based on liquidity and legacy trust—not technology or user experience. Its roots as a print publication (Controller weekly and Executive Controller monthly) are evident in its digital product. User complaints on the App Store consistently cite frustrating search redesigns, added complexity in the latest updates, and a general UX regression. One representative review states that the latest update added

unnecessary steps to what was previously a simple process, essentially making the experience worse to promote paid placements.

This is the classic “marketplace ripe for disruption” scenario: the incumbent has captured demand but has failed to innovate on product, creating an opening for a challenger that can match liquidity through superior experience and targeted market entry.

4. The AeroDesk Solution

4.1 Product Vision

AeroDesk is designed to be the “Webmotors of aviation”—a visually stunning, mobile-first marketplace that transforms how buyers and sellers interact in the pre-owned aircraft market. The platform combines three pillars:

1. **World-class UX:** High-resolution gallery views, 360-degree virtual cabin tours, intuitive filters by range/speed/seats/price/year/manufacturer, instant comparison tools, and a streamlined contact-to-seller flow.
2. **AI-Powered Intelligence:** Automated valuation models (AVM) based on transaction data, maintenance history scoring, market trend dashboards, and personalized aircraft recommendations for buyers.
3. **Integrated Transaction Support:** Pre-purchase inspection coordination, financing referrals (partnering with institutions like CurrencyAir), title/lien search integration, and ferry flight arrangement.

4.2 Key Features

Feature	Description
Smart Search & Filters	Filter by aircraft type, manufacturer, model, year, price, range, speed, passenger capacity, avionics package, engine program status, and geographic location.
AI Pricing Engine	Machine learning model trained on historical transactions, maintenance logs, and market conditions to provide estimated fair market value for any listed aircraft.
Virtual Tours	360-degree interior walkthroughs and high-resolution exterior galleries with zoom capability, inspired by luxury real estate platforms.
Dealer Dashboard	Analytics on listing views, lead quality, market comparisons, and inventory management tools—a significant upgrade over Sandhills’ Inventory Management app.
Buyer Match Alerts	Notification system that matches buyer preferences with new listings in real-time via push notification, email, and WhatsApp integration.
Financing Hub	Partnership with aircraft finance providers for instant pre-qualification, rate comparisons, and integrated loan application within the listing page.
Inspection Network	Vetted network of pre-purchase inspection facilities with scheduling, report tracking, and transparent pricing.
Multilingual Support	Launch in Portuguese and English, with Spanish for LatAm expansion. All UI, search, and support fully localized.

4.3 Business Name: AeroDesk

We recommend the name AeroDesk for the following reasons:

- **Memorable and global:** Short, easy to pronounce in English, Portuguese, and Spanish. Works across markets without localization.
- **Professional positioning:** “Desk” evokes a command center or trading desk—appropriate for high-value asset transactions. It implies professionalism over mere classifieds.
- **Domain availability:** aerodesk.com, aerodesk.com.br, and related social handles are highly likely to be available or acquirable.
- **Direct competitor contrast:** Positions clearly against “Controller” while suggesting a more modern, tech-forward alternative.

Alternative names considered: SkyDesk, WingTrade, AeroSpot, JetBase, FlightDeal.

5. Revenue Model & Financial Projections

5.1 Revenue Streams

Revenue Stream	Description	Pricing	Year 3 Target
Dealer Subscriptions	Monthly/annual plans: Basic (10 listings), Premium (50), Enterprise (unlimited)	$99/$299/$799/mo	$1,440K
Featured Listings	Premium placement on homepage, category pages, and search results	$199-$999/listing	$520K
Individual Listings	Pay-per-listing for private sellers and occasional dealers	$49-$149/listing	$280K
Financing Referrals	Commission from financing partners for successful loan originations	0.3-0.5% of loan value	$360K
Data & Analytics	Market reports, pricing intelligence subscriptions for brokers and funds	$199-$499/mo	$200K

5.2 Financial Projections (3-Year Summary)

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Revenue	$180K	$920K	$2,800K
Active Dealer Subscribers	40	150	380
Total Listings	600	2,200	5,500
Monthly Unique Visitors	25K	120K	400K
Operating Expenses	$680K	$980K	$2,400K
EBITDA	($500K)	($60K)	$400K

5.3 CAPEX & Startup Budget

Category	Estimated Cost (USD)
Product Development (MVP: web + mobile app)	$280,000
Design & Branding (UI/UX, logo, brand identity)	$45,000

Infrastructure (AWS/GCP, CDN, monitoring – 18 months)	$36,000
Marketing & Go-to-Market (first 18 months)	$240,000
Salaries & Operations (founding team – 18 months)	$240,000
Legal, Compliance & Company Setup	$30,000
Contingency (10%)	$49,000
TOTAL SEED REQUIREMENT	**$920,000**

5.4 Operating Expense Breakdown (Year 1)

Expense Category	Monthly	Annual
Engineering Team (2 full-stack devs + 1 mobile)	$12,000	$144,000
Product & Design (1 UI/UX designer)	$4,500	$54,000
Marketing & Content	$8,000	$96,000
Sales (1 BD manager + commission)	$6,000	$72,000
Founder Compensation (2 co-founders)	$10,000	$120,000
Cloud Infrastructure	$2,000	$24,000
Tools, SaaS & Misc	$2,000	$24,000
Legal & Accounting	$1,500	$18,000
TOTAL YEAR 1 OPEX	**$46,000**	**$552,000**

Note: Year 1 OPEX of $552K is lower than the $680K projected in the P&L because the P&L includes non-recurring costs from the CAPEX budget (design, legal setup, etc.) amortized over the first year.

6. Go-to-Market Strategy

6.1 Phase 1: Brazil Launch (Months 1–6)

Brazil is the ideal beachhead market for three reasons: deep domain expertise (your M&A background at Simpar provides direct access to aviation decision-makers), a large underserved market, and lower customer acquisition costs compared to the US.

Supply-Side Strategy (Getting Listings)

1. **LABACE 2025 Launch:** Attend LABACE (August 5–7, Campo de Marte, SP) as the product launch event. Secure 20–30 founding dealer partnerships with 90-day free Premium subscriptions.
2. **Broker Network Activation:** Direct outreach to the top 50 aircraft brokers and dealers in Brazil (TAM Aviacao Executiva, Global Aircraft, Lider Aviacao, etc.). Offer white-glove onboarding with professional photography service for initial listings.
3. **Data Seeding:** Aggregate publicly available listings from existing Brazilian platforms and ANAC registry data to build initial catalog. All listings tagged as “unverified” until claimed by sellers.
4. **ABAG Partnership:** Approach the Brazilian General Aviation Association for an institutional partnership—co-branded market reports and member benefits.

Demand-Side Strategy (Getting Buyers)

- **SEO-first content strategy:** Produce high-quality Portuguese content targeting keywords like “aeronave seminova”, “aviao executivo a venda”, and manufacturer-specific queries. Target position #1 for these long-tail terms within 6 months.
- **Social media & influencer:** Partner with Brazilian aviation YouTubers and Instagram accounts (aviation community in Brazil is highly active on social media). Sponsor content showcasing the AeroDesk experience.
- **Google Ads (targeted):** PPC campaigns on high-intent keywords. Aviation search queries in Portuguese have extremely low competition, making CPCs very attractive.
- **WhatsApp integration:** Given Brazil’s WhatsApp-centric business culture, every listing includes one-tap WhatsApp contact. Automated WhatsApp notifications for saved searches.

6.2 Phase 2: Latin America Expansion (Months 7–12)

Expand to key Latin American markets: Mexico (2nd largest LatAm aviation market), Colombia, Argentina, and Chile. Leverage Portuguese/Spanish dual-language platform. Partner with regional aviation associations and attend LABACE-equivalent events in each market.

6.3 Phase 3: Global English Market (Months 13–24)

Enter the US/global English market as a differentiated challenger to Controller.com. By this point, AeroDesk will have a proven product with 2,000+ active listings and strong unit economics from Brazil/LatAm. The go-to-market in the US will focus on targeting the “long tail” of private sellers and small brokers who find Controller’s pricing opaque and its UX frustrating, while simultaneously pursuing enterprise dealer partnerships.

7. Technology Roadmap & Claude Code Guide

7.1 Tech Stack

The recommended technology stack prioritizes rapid development, excellent mobile performance, and scalability:

Layer	Technology
Frontend (Web)	Next.js 14+ (App Router) with TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion
Frontend (Mobile)	React Native with Expo for iOS and Android
Backend API	Node.js with Express or Fastify, GraphQL (Apollo Server)
Database	PostgreSQL (Supabase) for structured data + Elasticsearch for search
Authentication	Supabase Auth (email, Google, Apple Sign-In)
File Storage	AWS S3 or Cloudflare R2 for images/documents
AI/ML	OpenAI API or Claude API for pricing engine; TensorFlow.js for client-side features
Payments	Stripe (global) + Pagar.me (Brazil-specific PIX/boleto)
Hosting	Vercel (web) + AWS (API) + Cloudflare CDN
Analytics	PostHog (self-hosted) + Google Analytics 4

7.2 Claude Code – Step-by-Step Build Guide

Below is a phased guide for building AeroDesk using Claude Code from your terminal. Each phase includes the prompt approach and expected output.

Phase 1: Project Scaffolding & Database (Week 1–2)

Prompt Claude Code to initialize the monorepo structure, set up the Next.js app with TypeScript and Tailwind, configure Supabase with PostgreSQL, and define the core data models: Aircraft, User, Dealer, Listing, Lead, Inquiry, Manufacturer, and AircraftModel. Include row-level security policies and migration scripts.

Phase 2: Authentication & User Profiles (Week 3)

Build the auth flow with Supabase Auth: email/password, Google OAuth, and Apple Sign-In. Create user profile pages with role-based access (buyer, private seller, dealer, admin). Include dealer verification workflow with document upload.

Phase 3: Listing Creation Flow (Week 4–5)

This is the core product experience. Build a multi-step listing wizard: aircraft details (type, manufacturer, model, year, serial number, registration), specifications (range, speed, seats, engines, avionics), condition and maintenance (TT, SMOH, program enrollment), pricing (asking

price, negotiable flag, financing available), and media upload (drag-and-drop multi-image with automatic compression and thumbnail generation). Each step should save progress to prevent data loss.

Phase 4: Search & Discovery (Week 6–7)

Implement Elasticsearch-powered search with faceted filters, auto-suggest, and real-time result updates. Build the listing detail page with image gallery, specifications table, maintenance timeline, similar aircraft carousel, and contact/inquiry form. Add comparison functionality (select up to 3 aircraft side-by-side).

Phase 5: Dealer Dashboard & Analytics (Week 8–9)

Build the dealer portal with listing management (CRUD), lead inbox with status tracking, performance analytics (views, inquiries, conversion funnel), and subscription/billing management via Stripe. Include bulk import capability (CSV/Excel) for dealers migrating from other platforms.

Phase 6: Mobile App (Week 10–13)

Build the React Native/Expo mobile app sharing business logic with the web app. Focus on the buyer experience: search, browse, save favorites, contact sellers, and push notification alerts for new listings matching saved criteria. Include biometric authentication and offline-capable listing cache.

Phase 7: AI Features & Fintech (Week 14–16)

Integrate the AI pricing engine: train on historical transaction data (initially seeded from public sources, then enriched with platform data over time). Build the financing hub with partner API integrations. Add automated market reports and valuation certificates that dealers can share with prospective buyers.

8. Team & Organization

8.1 Founding Team Requirements

The ideal founding team for AeroDesk combines three competencies:

- **CEO / Business Lead:** M&A and transaction expertise, aviation industry network, fundraising capability. Deep understanding of deal economics and buyer/seller psychology in high-value asset transactions.
- **CTO / Technical Lead:** Full-stack engineering with marketplace experience. Must be capable of building the MVP with a small team (2–3 engineers) and scaling to production. Experience with search infrastructure (Elasticsearch) and mobile development is critical.
- **Head of Growth / Marketing:** Marketplace growth expertise with specific experience in SEO, content marketing, and two-sided marketplace dynamics. Ideally someone who has scaled a marketplace in Brazil or Latin America.

8.2 Year 1 Org Chart

Role	Count	Location	Hiring Timeline
CEO / Co-founder	1	SP, Brazil	Day 1
CTO / Co-founder	1	SP or Remote	Day 1
Full-stack Engineers	2	Remote (Brazil)	Month 2
Mobile Developer	1	Remote (Brazil)	Month 4
UI/UX Designer	1	Remote (Brazil)	Month 1
BD / Sales Manager	1	SP, Brazil	Month 3
Content / SEO Specialist	1	Remote	Month 3
TOTAL HEADCOUNT (Year 1)	**8**		

9. Key Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
Cold-start problem	Without listings, no buyers visit; without buyers, no dealers list	High	Aggressive supply seeding: free listings for first 100 dealers, data aggregation from public sources, and manual broker outreach
Controller.com retaliation	Incumbent could improve UX or offer aggressive pricing to Brazilian market	Medium	Move fast on Brazil (where Controller has minimal presence), build network effects before they can respond
Regulatory complexity	Cross-border aircraft transactions involve complex import/export regulations	Medium	Focus initially on domestic Brazilian transactions; partner with aviation law firms for cross-border deals
High-value fraud risk	Aircraft marketplace could attract sophisticated scams	Medium	Mandatory dealer verification, escrow partnerships, and flagging system for suspicious listings
Economic downturn	Aviation is cyclical; recession could reduce transaction volume	Low-Medium	Diversify revenue beyond transactions (data analytics, SaaS tools for dealers); used aircraft demand actually increases in downturns as buyers seek value
Talent acquisition	Difficulty hiring engineers with marketplace and aviation domain expertise	Medium	Remote-first team in Brazil; competitive equity packages; leverage Claude Code / AI tools to maximize small team output

10. Milestones & Timeline

Milestone	Deliverable	Target Date
M1: Company Formation	Legal entity (Brazil), brand registration, domain acquisition, founding team assembled	Q2 2026
M2: MVP Web Launch	Listing creation, search, dealer dashboard, payment processing live in Brazil	Q3 2026
M3: LABACE Launch Event	Product showcase at LABACE 2026, 30 founding dealer partnerships signed	Aug 2026
M4: 500 Active Listings	Organic growth + BD efforts achieve critical mass of listings in Brazil	Q4 2026
M5: Mobile App Launch	iOS and Android apps published on App Store and Google Play	Q4 2026
M6: AI Pricing Engine Beta	Automated valuation tool available for Premium/Enterprise subscribers	Q1 2027
M7: LatAm Expansion	Mexico and Colombia markets open with localized content and dealer partnerships	Q2 2027
M8: 2,000 Active Listings	Platform reaches liquidity threshold for self-sustaining marketplace dynamics	Q2 2027
M9: Financing Hub Live	Integrated financing with 2–3 lending partners	Q3 2027
M10: US Market Entry	English-language platform with US dealer partnerships, competing directly with Controller.com	Q4 2027
M11: Series A Readiness	Positive unit economics, 5,000+ listings, 400K+ monthly visitors, clear path to profitability	Q1 2028

11. Conclusion

The pre-owned aircraft market is a USD 37+ billion industry served by legacy platforms that prioritize advertising revenue over user experience. AeroDesk represents a generational opportunity to build the definitive digital marketplace for aircraft transactions—starting with the underserved Brazilian market and scaling globally.

The thesis is straightforward: apply proven digital marketplace principles (consumer-grade UX, mobile-first design, AI-powered intelligence, integrated financing) to a high-value vertical that has been overlooked by modern tech entrepreneurs. Controller.com generates an estimated USD 18 million in revenue with 1990s-era technology—imagine what a platform built with 2026 capabilities can achieve.

With an initial investment of approximately USD 920,000, AeroDesk can reach positive EBITDA by Year 3 with a clear path to scaling to 5,500+ listings and 400,000+ monthly visitors. The combination of deep M&A expertise, understanding of Brazilian aviation dynamics, and ability to leverage AI tools (including Claude Code for rapid development) creates a unique founder-market fit.

Next steps: Secure domain and brand assets, finalize founding team composition, begin MVP development using the Claude Code roadmap outlined in Section 7, and prepare for LABACE 2026 as the launch event.

AeroDesk – The Sky is the Starting Point